

VM Deletion Watchdog

Scope: Analytics Rule → Automation Rule → Playbook, for **Azure VM deletion** only.

Step 1: Enable the Azure Activity Data Connector (Content Hub)

This is what populates the `AzureActivity` table your analytics rule depends on.

1. In the **Microsoft Sentinel** portal, go to your workspace.
2. Left menu → **Content Hub**.
3. Search for **Azure Activity**.
4. Click it → **Install** (this deploys the solution: connector + any bundled workbooks/analytics templates).
5. Once installed, go to **Configuration** → **Data connectors** (left menu).
6. Search for **Azure Activity** → open it.
7. You'll see a button/link like "**Launch Azure Policy Assignment wizard**" — this is because Azure Activity ingestion is enabled via an Azure Policy that configures Diagnostic Settings across your subscription(s), not a simple toggle like other connectors.

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Azure Activity

Status: All Content type: All Support: All Provider: All Category: All Content sources: All

Install/Update Delete

Content title	Status	Content source	Provider	Support
☒ Azure Activity FEATURED	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
Azure Activity	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
AzureActivity Administration From VPS Providers	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
Rare subscription-level operations in Azure	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
Azure storage key enumeration	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
Port opened for an Azure Resource	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
Anomalous Azure Operation Hunting Model	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
Azure Virtual Network Subnets Administrative ...	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft
Creation of expensive computes in Azure	Installed	Solution	Microsoft	Microsoft

Previous Page 1 of 1 Next Showing 1 to 20 of 20 results.

Azure Activity

Microsoft Provider Microsoft Support 3.0.4 Version

Description

Note: Please refer to the following before installing the solution:

- Review the solution [Release Notes](#)

The *Azure Activity* solution for Microsoft Sentinel enables you to ingest Azure Activity Administrative, Security, Service Health, Alert, Recommendation, Policy, Autoscale and Resource Health logs using Diagnostic Settings into Microsoft Sentinel.

Data Connectors: 1. [Workbooks](#) 2. [Analytic Rules](#) 14. [Hunting Queries](#) 15

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Content type

Analytics rule 14 Data connector 1 Hunting query 15

Category

IT Operations

Pricing

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Device specific AMA connectors have been deprecated. [Learn more](#)

In anticipation of the End of Support of the HTTP Data Collector API, Azure Function-based data connectors using legacy API will not be supported after September 14, 2026. Please update to OCF-based data connectors. [Learn more](#)

6 Connectors 2 Connected More content at Content Hub

Search by name or provider Providers: Microsoft

Data Types: All Status: All

Status	Connector name	Updates
☒	Azure Activity Microsoft	...
☒	Microsoft 365 Insider Ri... Microsoft	...
☒	Microsoft Entra ID Microsoft	...
☒	[DEPRECATED] Security ... Microsoft	Deprecated
☒	Windows Forwarded Eve... Microsoft	...
☒	Windows Security Event... Microsoft	...

Azure Activity

Disconnected Status Microsoft Provider Last Log Received

Description

Azure Activity Log is a subscription log that provides insight into subscription-level events that occur in Azure, including events from Azure Resource Manager operational data, service health events, write operations taken on the resources in your subscription, and the status of activities performed in Azure.

Last data received

Content source Azure Activity Version 2.0.0

Author Microsoft Supported by Microsoft Corporation Email

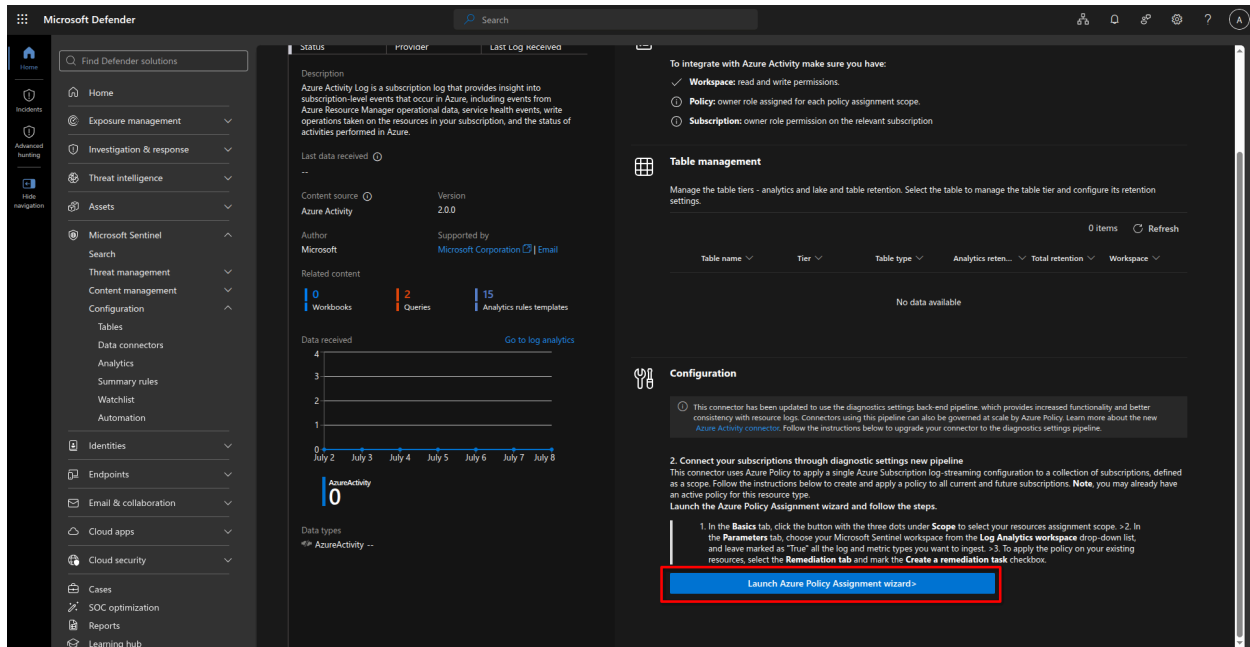
Related content

0 Workbooks 2 Queries 15 Analytics rules templates

Data types

AzureActivity

Open connector page



Step 2: Configure Diagnostic Settings (the actual data flow)

You have two ways to do this — pick one:

Option A: Via the Policy wizard (recommended for full subscription coverage)

1. From the connector page, launch the **Diagnostic Settings policy assignment**.
2. Scope: select your **subscription** (the one your lab VM lives in).
3. It creates a Diagnostic Setting that forwards Activity Log categories (Administrative, Security, etc.) to your Sentinel-connected Log Analytics workspace.
4. Assign the policy — note it can take some time to remediate/apply if resources already exist; you may need to trigger a **remediation task** for it to backfill onto existing resources instead of just new ones.

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Assign policy

Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

Scope

Scope *

Exclusions

Resource selectors (Expand)

Basics

Policy definition *

Version *

Overrides (Expand)

Assignment name *

Description

Policy enforcement ☒ Enabled

Previous Next Review + create

Scope

Subscription

Ayman-Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription - MPN

Resource Group

ayman-rg-test1

Select Cancel Clear All Selections Give feedback

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Home

Assign policy

Basics Parameters Remediation Managed identity Non-compliance messages Review + create

Scope

Scope *

Exclusions

Resource selectors (Expand)

Basics

Policy definition *

Version *

Overrides (Expand)

Assignment name *

Description

Policy enforcement ☒ Enabled

Previous Next Review + create

Select policy version

This policy definition has the following versions. Select the one you would like to assign. Learn more about policy definition versions

The option you select will determine the major version this assignment will reference. You can choose whether to automatically enroll in minor version upgrades and/or previews. All assignments will always receive patch changes.

Version updates

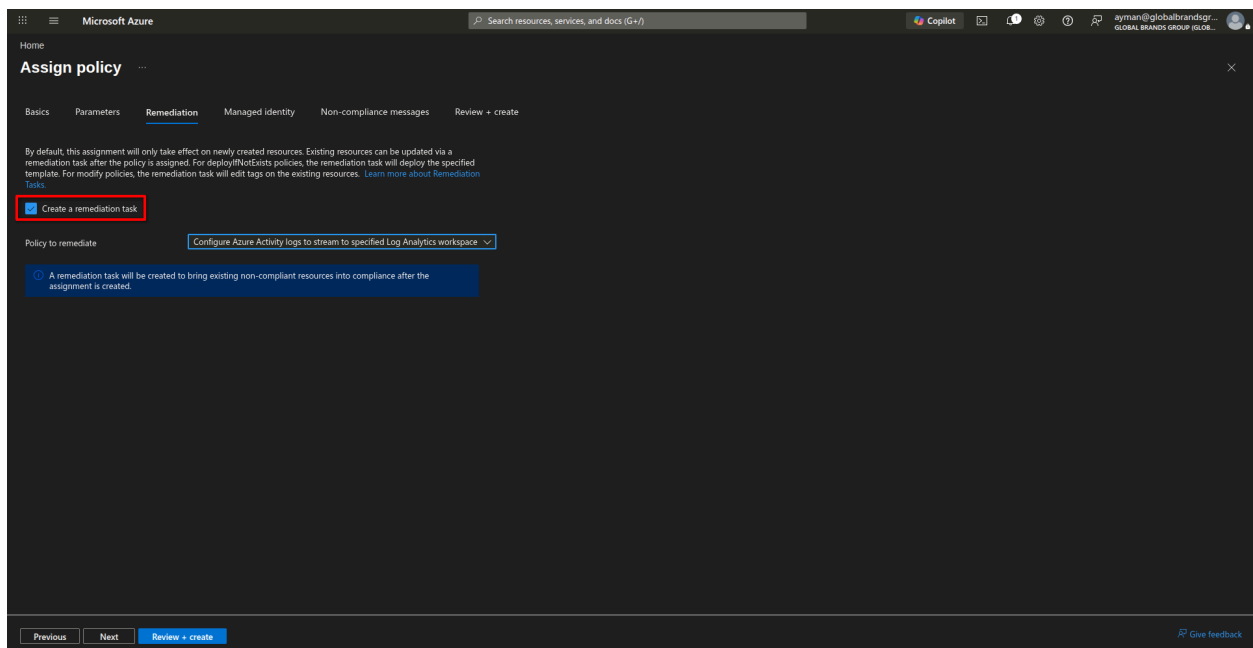
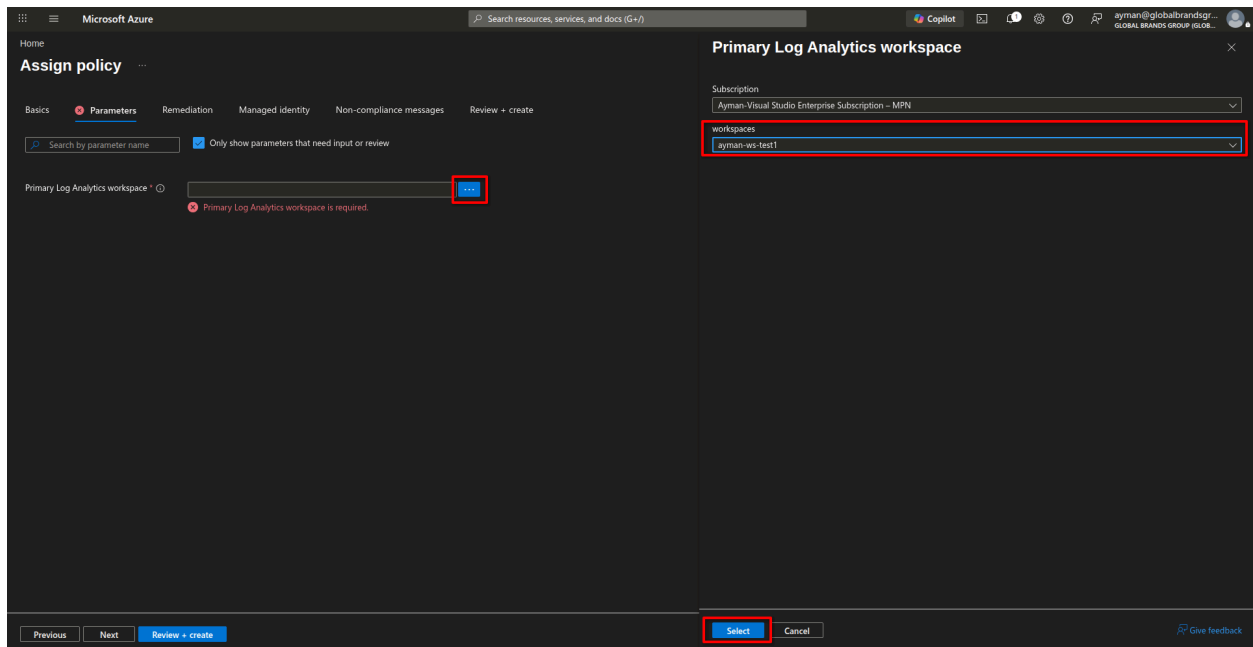
Automatically enroll in minor version changes ☐ No

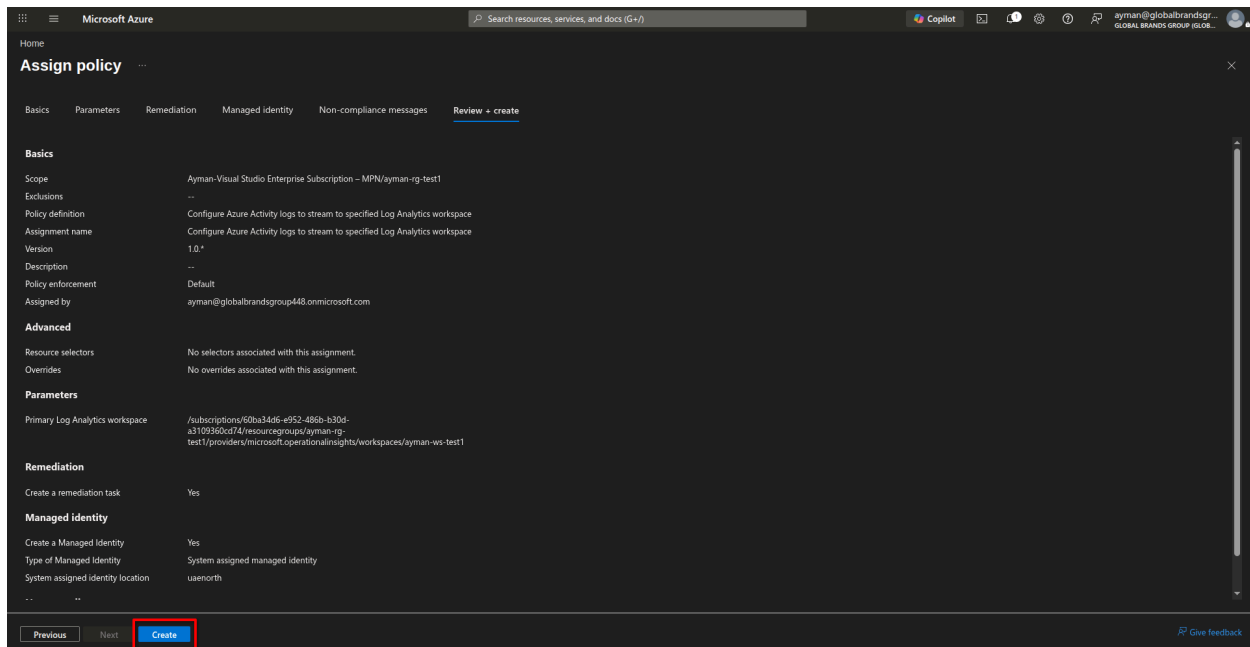
Version	Assignments
☒ 1.0 *	0

Include preview versions ☐ No

Selected version 1.0 *

Select Cancel Give feedback





Option B: Manual Diagnostic Setting (faster for a single subscription, good for lab/testing)

1. Go to **Subscriptions** in the Azure Portal → select your subscription.
2. Left menu → **Activity Log** → **Export Activity Logs** (near top).
3. **+ Add diagnostic setting.**
4. **Diagnostic setting name:** type something like `sentinel-activity-log`
5. Choose **Administrative logs**.
6. Under **Destination details**, check **Send to Log Analytics workspace**.
7. Two new dropdowns will appear — select:
 - **Subscription:** your Sentinel-connected subscription
 - **Log Analytics workspace:** the workspace tied to your Sentinel instance
8. Click **Save** (top left).

You need **Owner** or **Monitoring Contributor** at the subscription scope to do this. If you only have Contributor on a resource group, this step will fail — check your role assignment first if the option is greyed out.

Microsoft Azure

Home > Resource Manager > Subscriptions > Ayman-Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription – MPN

Resource Manager | Subscriptions

global brands group

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Copilot

ayman@globalbrandsgr... GLOBAL BRANDS GROUP (GLOB...

Subscriptions

Subscriptions: Filtered (1 of 5)

My role == all

Status == all

Add filter

Subscription name ↑↓

Ayman-Visual Studio Enterprise Subs

Ayman-Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription – MPN | Activity log

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Looking for Log Analytics? In Log Analytics you can search for performance, diagnostics, health logs, and more. [Visit Log Analytics](#)

Quick Insights

Management Group: None

Subscriptions: Ayman-Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription – M...

Event severity: All

Timespan: Last 6 hours

Add Filter

0 items.

Operation name	Status	Time	Time stamp	Subscription	Event initiated by
No results to display					

No events to display

Change your filters by subscription, timespan, category, or more to see some events.

[Learn more about Azure Activity Log](#)

Microsoft Azure

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Diagnostic settings

What is the purpose of diagnostic settings? Can you explain how to send diagnostic logs to Azure Monitor? How do diagnostic settings differ from other Azure services?

Refresh Feedback

Subscription

Ayman-Visual Studio Enterprise Subscription – MPN

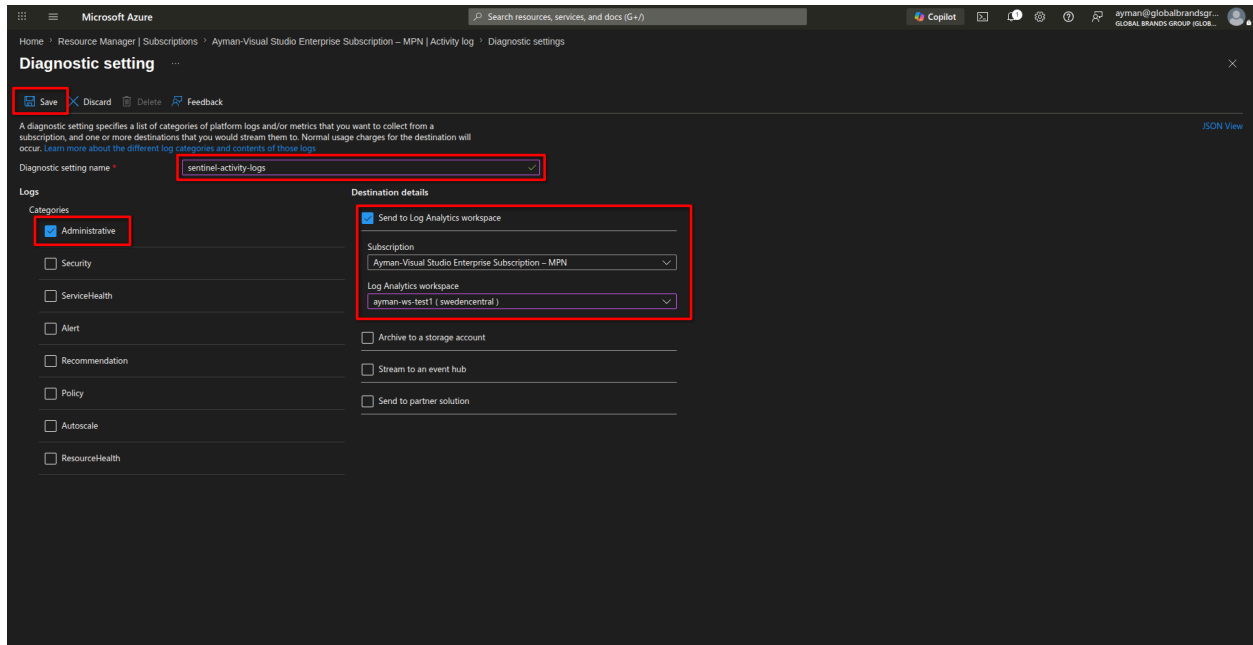
Diagnostic settings are used to configure streaming export of platform logs and metrics for a subscription to the destination of your choice. You may create up to five different diagnostic settings to send different logs and metrics to independent destinations. [Learn more about diagnostic settings.](#)

Diagnostic settings	Name	Storage account	Event hub	Log Analytics workspace	Partner solution	Edit setting
sentinel-activity-log		-	-	ayman-ws-test1	-	Edit setting

[Add diagnostic setting](#)

Click 'Add Diagnostic setting' above to configure the collection of the following data:

- Administrative
- Security
- ServiceHealth
- Alert
- Recommendation
- Policy
- Autoscale
- ResourceHealth



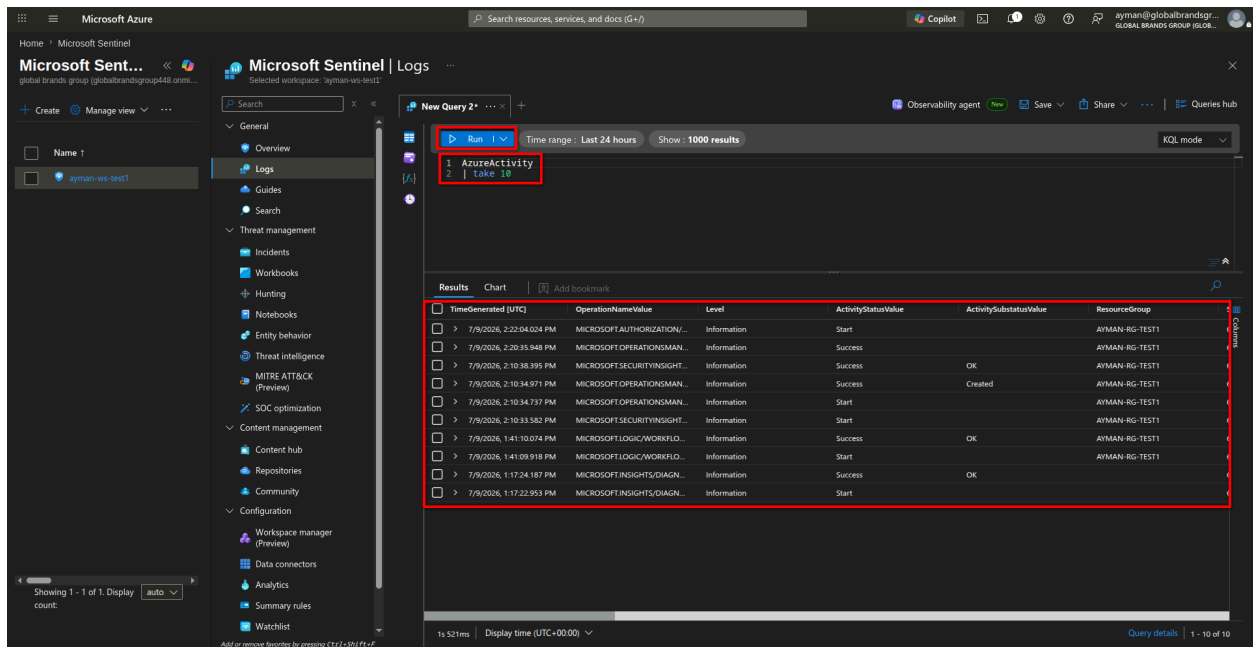
Step 3: Verify Data Is Flowing

Don't build the rule blind. Confirm ingestion first.

1. Sentinel → **Logs** (left menu).
2. Run:

```
AzureActivity  
| take 10
```

1. If empty, wait 10–15 minutes (initial ingestion has latency), then retry. If still empty after ~30 min, revisit Step 2 — most common cause is scope mismatch (diagnostic setting on the wrong subscription) or the Administrative category not being checked.



Step 4: Build and Test the KQL Query

Before wrapping it in an analytics rule, validate the query in **Logs**:

```
AzureActivity
| where OperationNameValue == "MICROSOFT.COMPUTE/VIRTUALMACHINES/DELETE"
| where ActivityStatusValue == "Success"
| project
    TimeGenerated,
    Caller,
    CallerIpAddress,
    ResourceGroup,
    Resource,
    _ResourceId,
    SubscriptionId,
    ActivityStatusValue
```

To test this actually fires, delete a throwaway VM in your subscription and re-run the query — you should see the row appear within a few minutes.

Notes:

- Caller** = UPN or Appld of whoever issued the delete.

- Filtering `ActivityStatusValue == "Success"` means you only catch completed deletions. You could build a second, lower-severity rule later for **failed** delete attempts (`ActivityStatusValue == "Failure"`) as an early-warning signal — not covered here since you asked to keep this focused.
-

Step 5: Create the Analytics Rule

1. Sentinel → **Analytics** (left menu) → **+ Create** → **Scheduled query rule**.

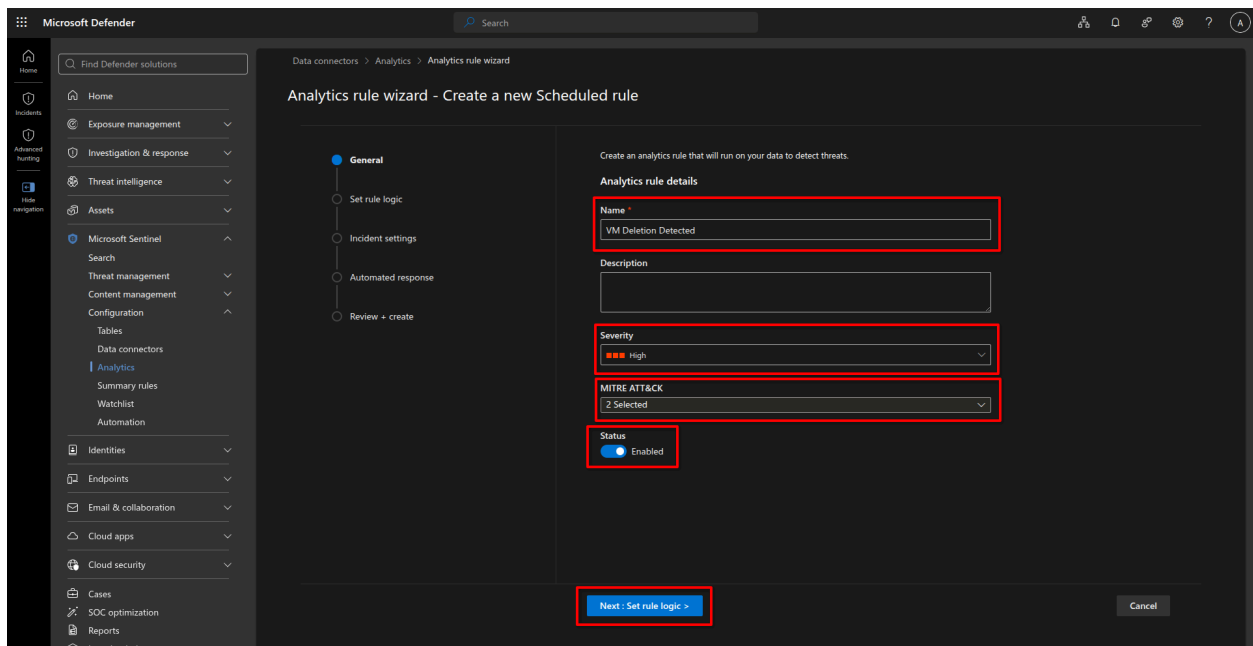
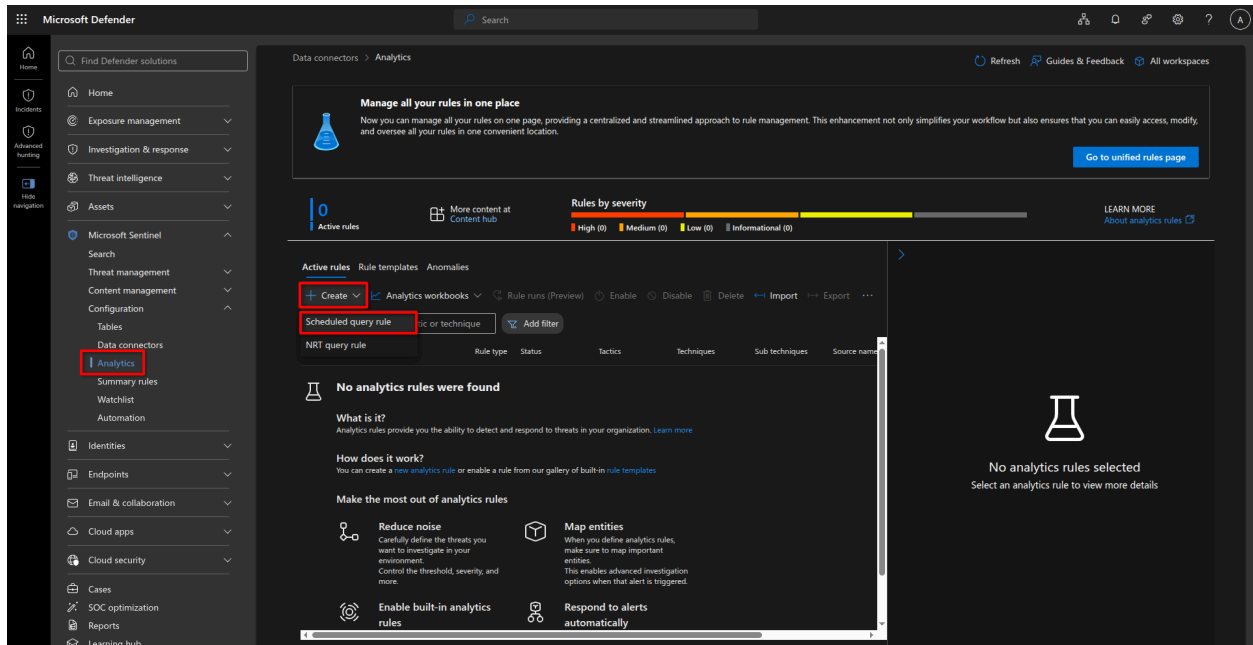
2. **General tab:**

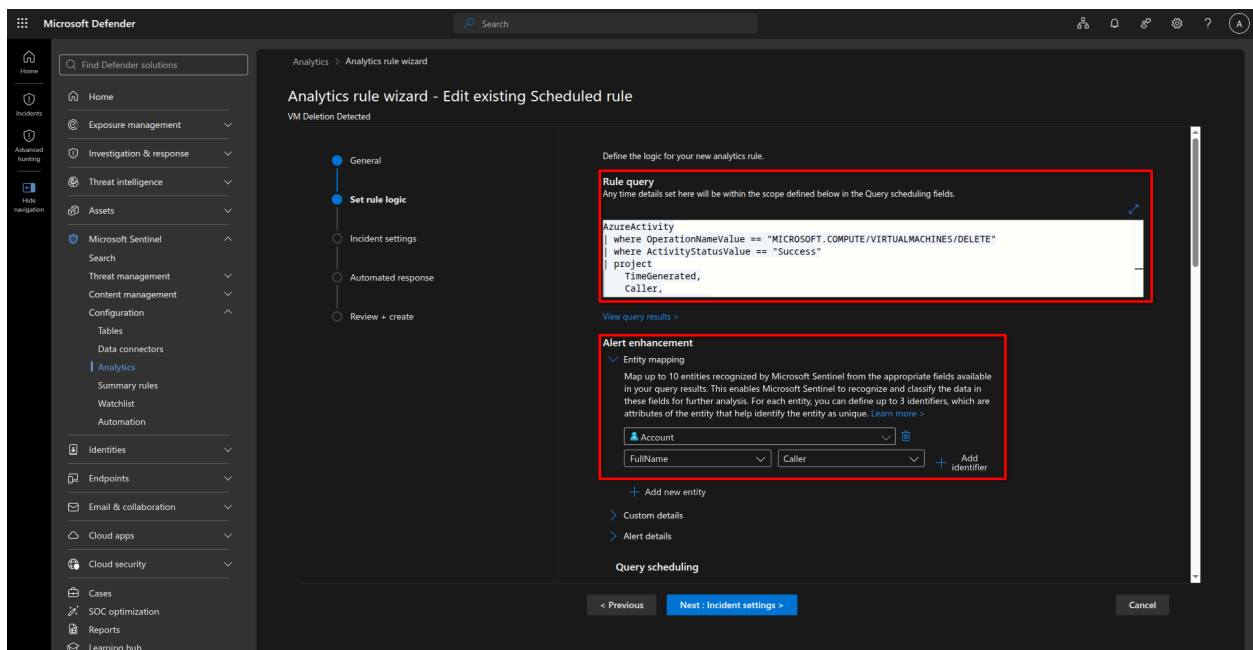
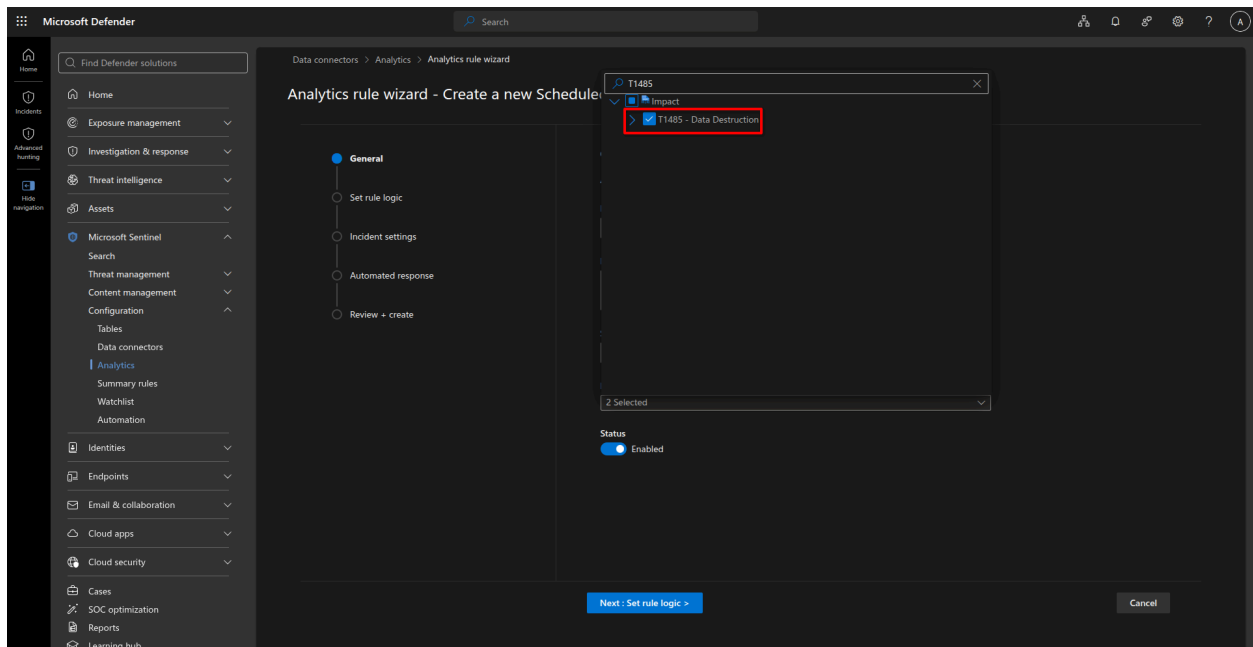
- Name: `VM Deletion Detected`
- Description: brief note on what it catches
- Severity: **High**
- MITRE ATT&CK tactic: **Impact** → technique **T1485 – Data Destruction**
- Status: Enabled

3. **Set rule logic tab:**

- Paste the KQL from Step 4.
- **Entity mapping** — this is important for the automation rule and playbook to have context later:
 - Entity type: **Account** → Identifier: `Full Name` → mapped to `Caller`
 - Entity type: **IP** → Identifier: `Address` → mapped to `CallerIpAddress`
 - Entity type: **Azure Resource** → Identifier: `Resource ID` → mapped to `_ResourceId`
- **Query scheduling:** Run every 5–15 minutes, lookback matching the run interval.
- **Alert threshold:** Trigger when results > 0.
- **Event grouping:** "Group all events into a single alert" is usually fine here unless you expect bulk deletions to warrant separate alerts.
- **Suppression:** leave off unless you have a noisy testing loop going.

4. **Incident settings tab:** Enable "Create incidents from alerts triggered by this rule" (on by default).
5. **Automated response tab:** Skip for now — you'll wire this up via the Automation Rule in Step 6, not here (keeps logic centralized and reusable across rules later).
6. **Review + create.**





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Data connectors > Analytics > Analytics rule wizard

Analytics rule wizard - Create a new Scheduled rule

General

Set rule logic

Incident settings

Automated response

Review + create

Query scheduling

Run query every *
5 Minutes

Lookup data from the last *
5 Minutes

Start running
☒ Automatically
☐ At specific time (Preview)
 7/11/2025 12:00 PM
 Starting automatically, the rule will run every 5 minutes, looking up data from last 5 minutes.

Alert threshold

Generate alert when number of query results *
Is greater than 0

Event grouping

Configure how rule query results are grouped into alerts
☒ Group all events into a single alert
☐ Trigger an alert for each event

Suppression

< Previous Next: Incident settings > Cancel

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Analytics rule wizard - Create a new Scheduled rule

General

Set rule logic

Incident settings

Automated response

Review + create

Incident settings

alerts can be grouped together into an Incident that should be looked into. You can set whether the alerts that are triggered by this analytics rule should generate incidents.

Create incidents from alerts triggered by this analytics rule
☒ Enabled

Alert grouping

☐ Microsoft Defender correlation activities can link other alerts or merge existing incidents to the generated incident, regardless of the alert grouping settings defined in the analytics rule.

Set how the alerts that are triggered by this analytics rule, are grouped into incidents. Grouping alerts into incidents provides the context you need to respond and reduces the noise from single alerts.

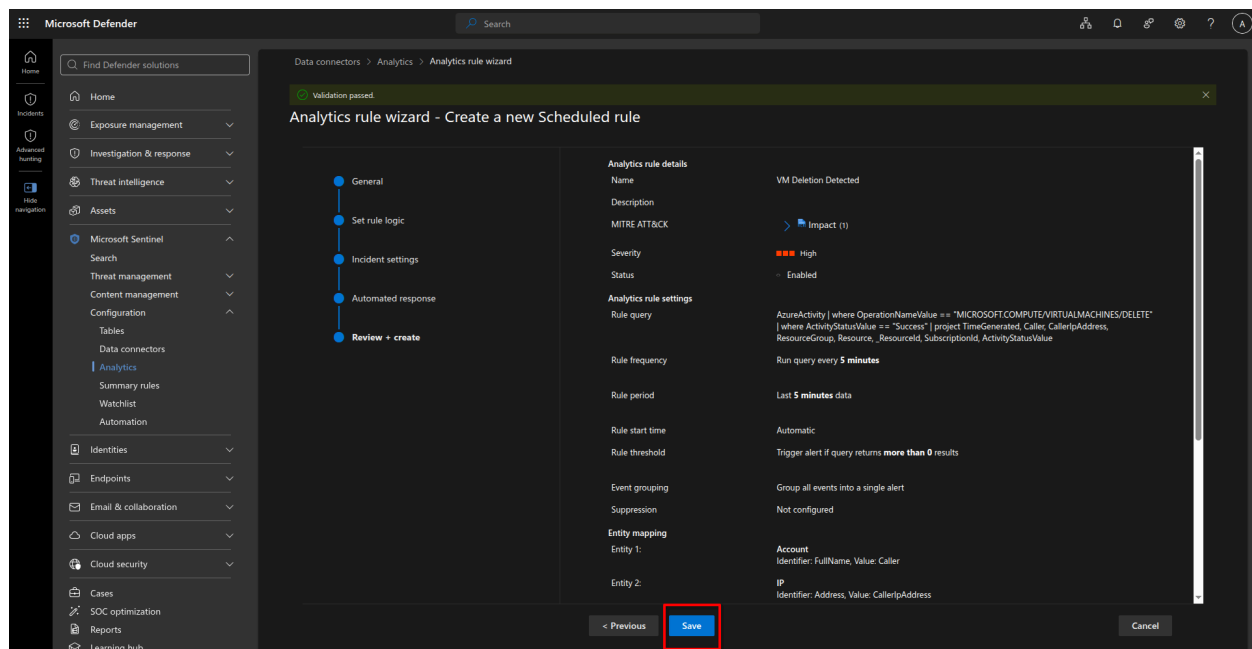
Group related alerts, triggered by this analytics rule, into incidents
☒ Disabled

Limit the group to alerts created within the selected time frame *
 5 Hours

Group alerts triggered by this analytics rule into a single incident by
☒ Grouping alerts into a single incident if all the entities match (recommended)
☐ Grouping all alerts triggered by this rule into a single incident
☐ Grouping alerts into a single incident if the selected entity types and details match:
 Select entities
 Select details

By using shared correlation rules

< Previous Next: Automated response > Cancel

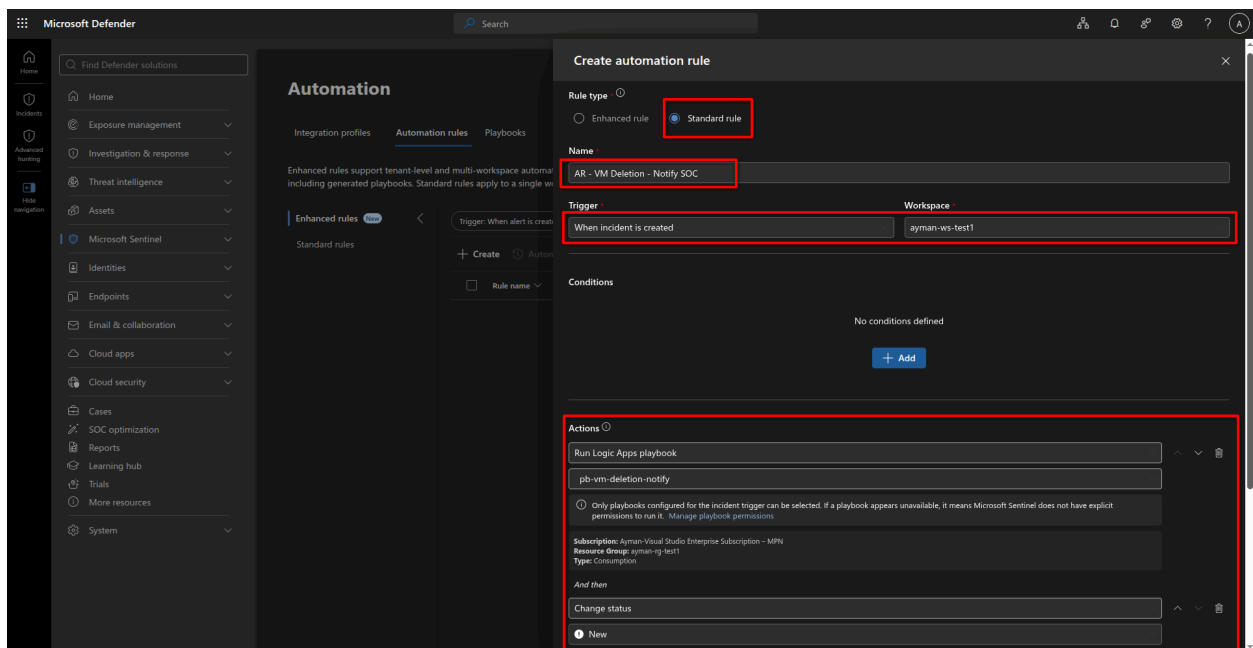
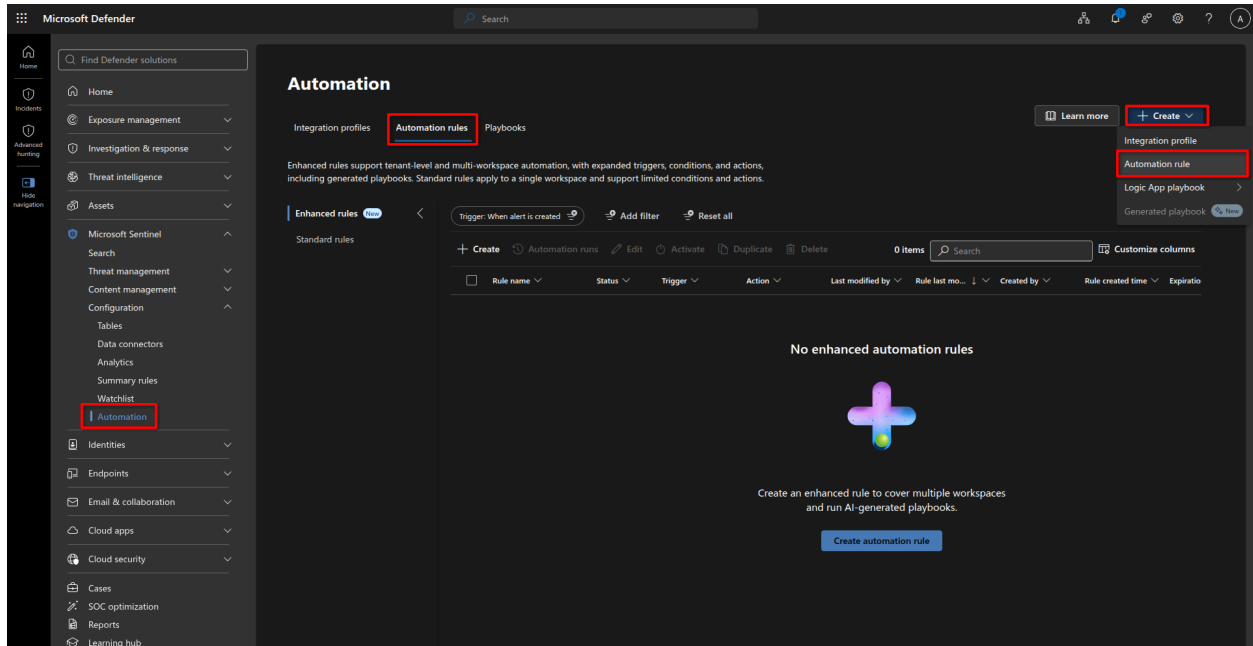


Step 6: Create the Automation Rule

Automation rules live at the Sentinel level and decide when a playbook fires, plus handle incident-level actions (status, severity, tagging) without needing that logic inside the Logic App.

1. Sentinel → **Automation** (left menu) → **+ Create** → **Automation rule**.
2. **Name:** `AR - VM Deletion - Notify SOC`
3. **Trigger:** When incident is created
4. **Conditions:**
 - Analytics rule name **equals** `VM Deletion Detected`
 - (Optional) Add a condition on **Account** to exclude known-good automation identities, e.g. `Caller does not contain "sentinel-automation-sp"`, if you have a legitimate cleanup service principal that regularly deletes VMs.
5. **Actions:**
 - Action 1: **Run playbook** → select the Logic App from Step 7 (you'll need to build the playbook first, or come back and add this action after Step 7)

- Action 2: **Change status** → New (don't auto-close; a human should confirm intent on something destructive)
6. **Order:** 1 (or whatever fits alongside your other automation rules)
 7. **Expiration:** None, unless this is temporary/lab-only.
 8. Save.



Step 7: Build the Playbook (Logic App)

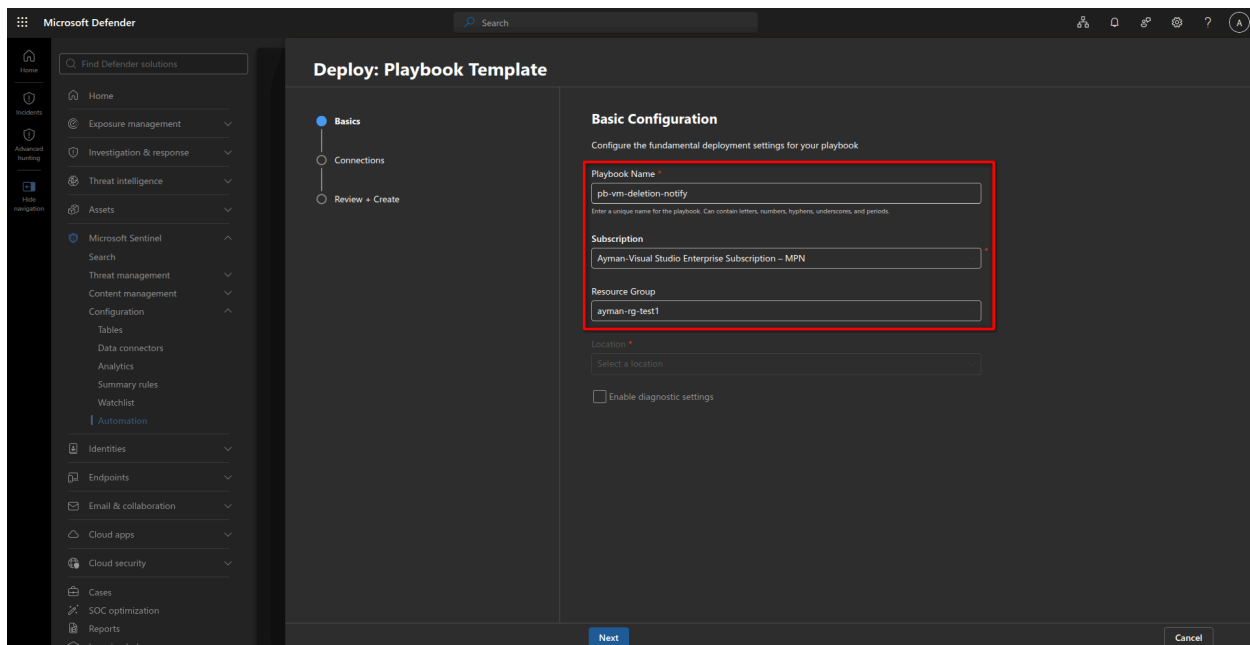
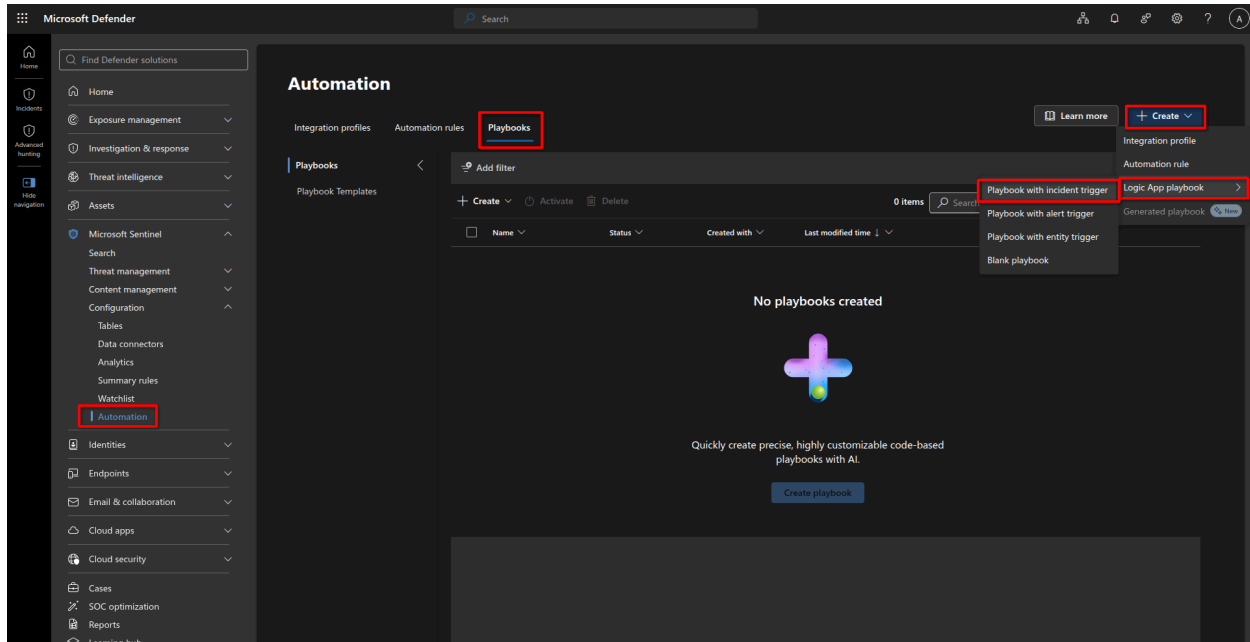
Purpose: enrich + notify. Deletion is already done and largely irreversible, so the playbook's job is to get the right context in front of a human fast, not to auto-remediate.

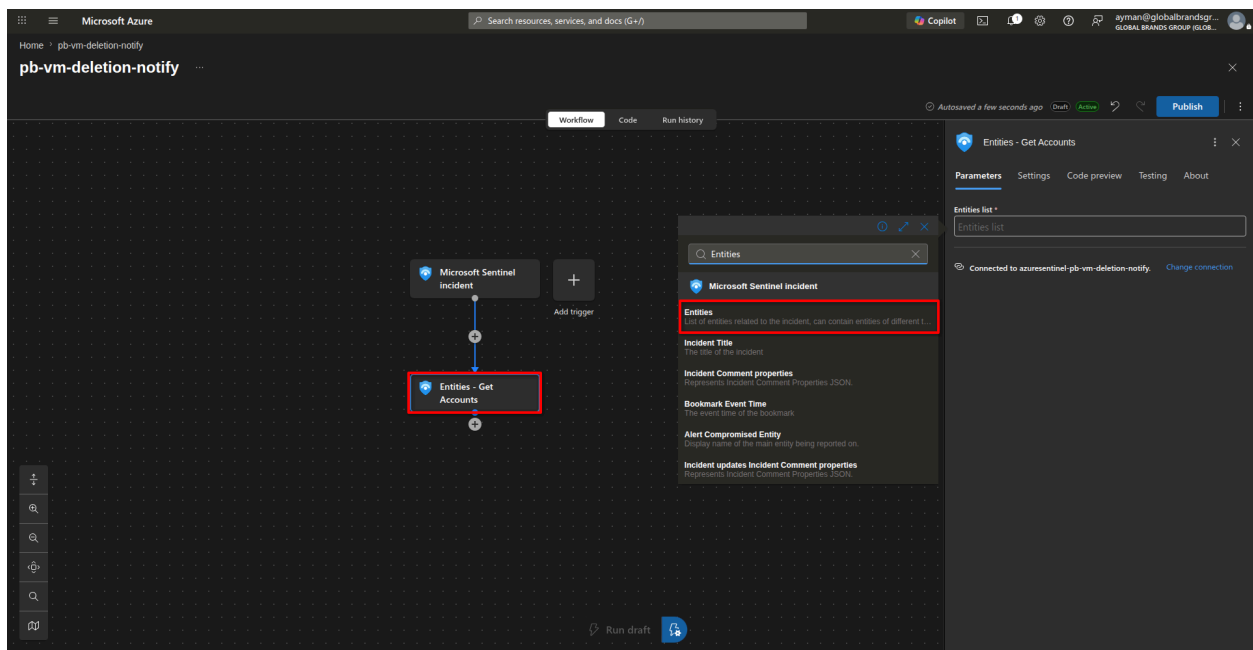
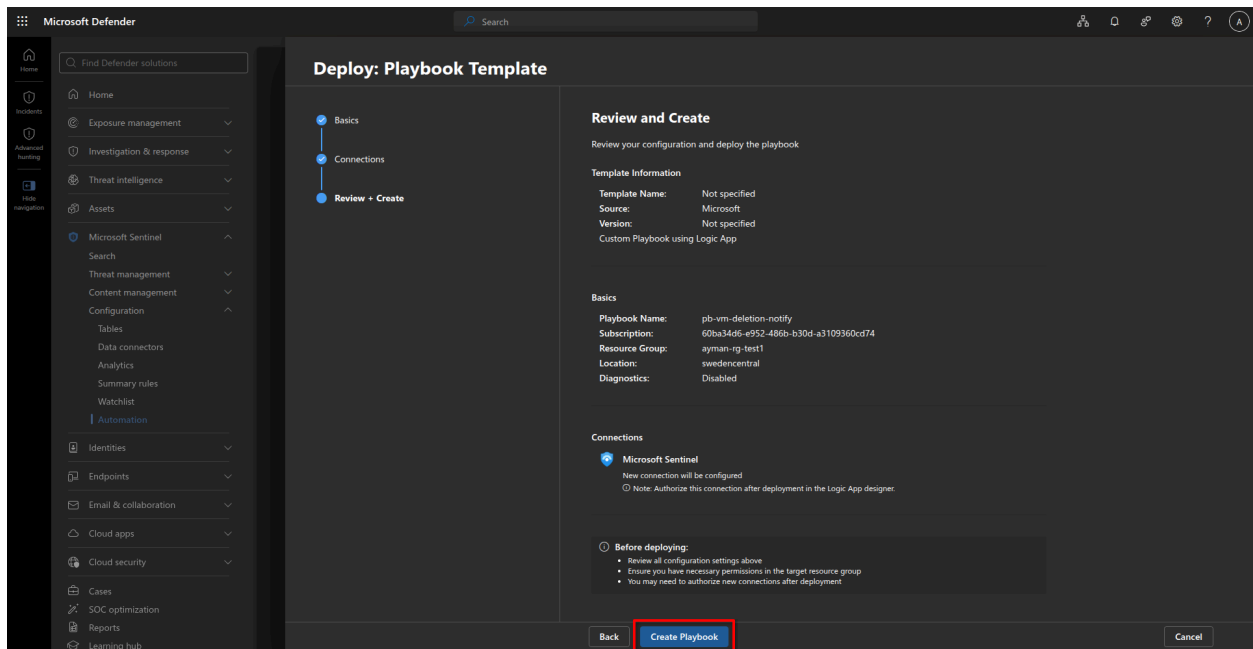
1. Sentinel → **Automation** → **Playbooks** tab → **+ Add new**.
2. This opens the Logic App creation blade in Azure. Pick your subscription, resource group, region, name it (e.g. `pb-vm-deletion-notify`), and create it — this deploys an empty Logic App and opens the Logic App Designer.
3. **Trigger:** Search for and add "**Microsoft Sentinel incident**" trigger (this is the modern incident-based trigger — gives you full entity context, unlike the older alert-based trigger).
4. **First-time connection setup:** You'll be prompted to create a connection for the Microsoft Sentinel connector — sign in with an account that has Sentinel access. (For production, swap this to an app registration/service principal later so it doesn't break if a personal account's password rotates — fine to use personal login for lab/testing now.)
5. **Add action: Entities – Get Accounts** (Microsoft Sentinel connector action) — pulls the mapped Account entity (your `Caller`) from the incident.
6. **Add action: Entities – Get Hosts** — pulls the mapped Account entity (your `Caller`) from the incident.
7. **Add action: Post message in a chat or channel** (Microsoft Teams connector) — first use will prompt Teams OAuth consent; the account/bot needs to already be a member of your target channel.
 - Message body, using dynamic content from the trigger/actions above:

```
🔴 VM Deletion Detected
Actor: [Account entity output – UserPrincipalName]
Resource: [Azure Resource entity output – Name]
Source IP: [from trigger – CallerIpAddress via alert properties]
```

8. Save the Logic App.

9. **Test it in isolation first:** Use "Run Trigger" manually or trigger a test incident before relying on the Automation Rule to fire it — isolates playbook bugs from automation-rule/analytics-rule bugs.





Microsoft Azure

Home > pb-vm-deletion-notify

pb-vm-deletion-notify

Workflow Code Run history

Microsoft Sentinel Incident

Entities - Get Accounts

For each

Post message in a chat or channel

Run draft

Post message in a chat or channel

Parameters Settings Code preview Testing About

Post as *
Flow bot

Post in *
Chat with Flow bot

Recipient *
muhammad.fathy@gbrands.com

Message *

VM Deletion Detected
Actor:

Advanced parameters
Showing 0 of 2 Show all Clear all

Connected to Muhammad Fathy@gbrands.com. Change connection

Microsoft Azure

Home > pb-vm-deletion-notify

pb-vm-deletion-notify

Workflow Code Run history

Microsoft Sentinel Incident

Entities - Get Accounts

For each

Post message in a chat or channel

Run draft

Post message in a chat or channel

Parameters Settings Code preview Testing About

Post as *
Flow bot

Post in *
Chat with Flow bot

Recipient *
muhammad.fathy@gbrands.com

Message *

VM Deletion Detected
Actor:

Advanced parameters
Showing 0 of 2 Show all Clear all

Connected to Muhammad Fathy@gbrands.com. Change connection

Function Dynamic content

Entities - Get Accounts

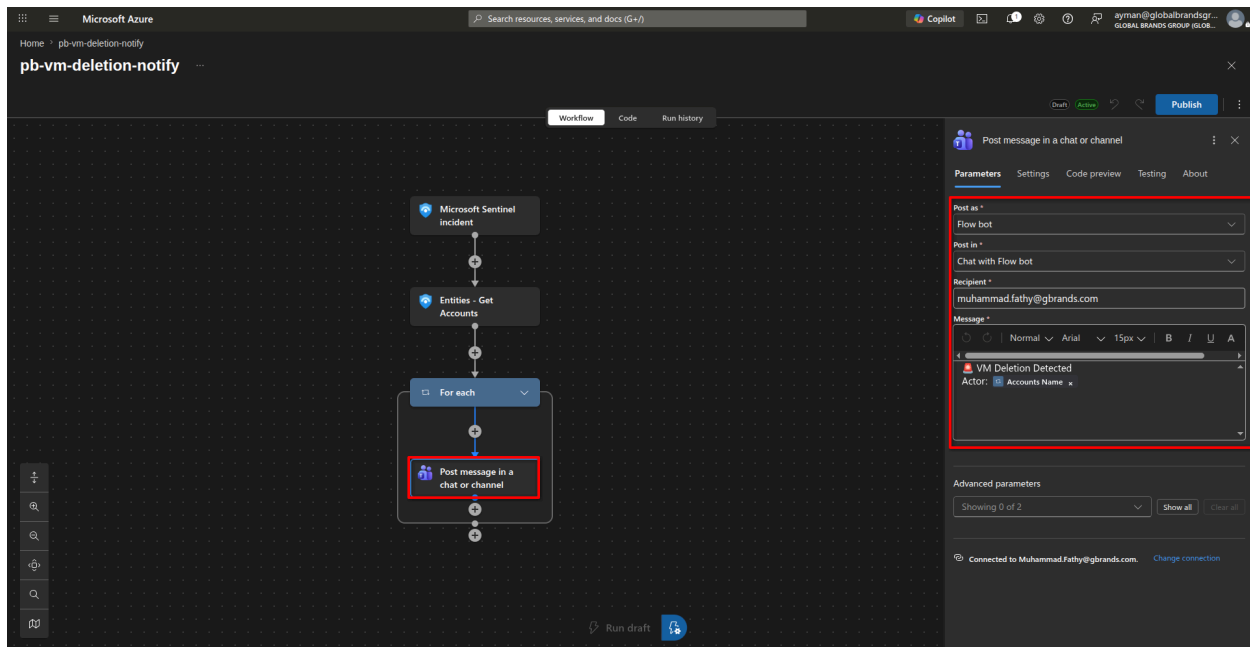
Accounts Name
Account name

Accounts DnsDomain
The fully qualified domain DNS name

Accounts UPN suffix
User principal name suffix

Accounts SID
Account security identifier, e.g. S-1-5-18

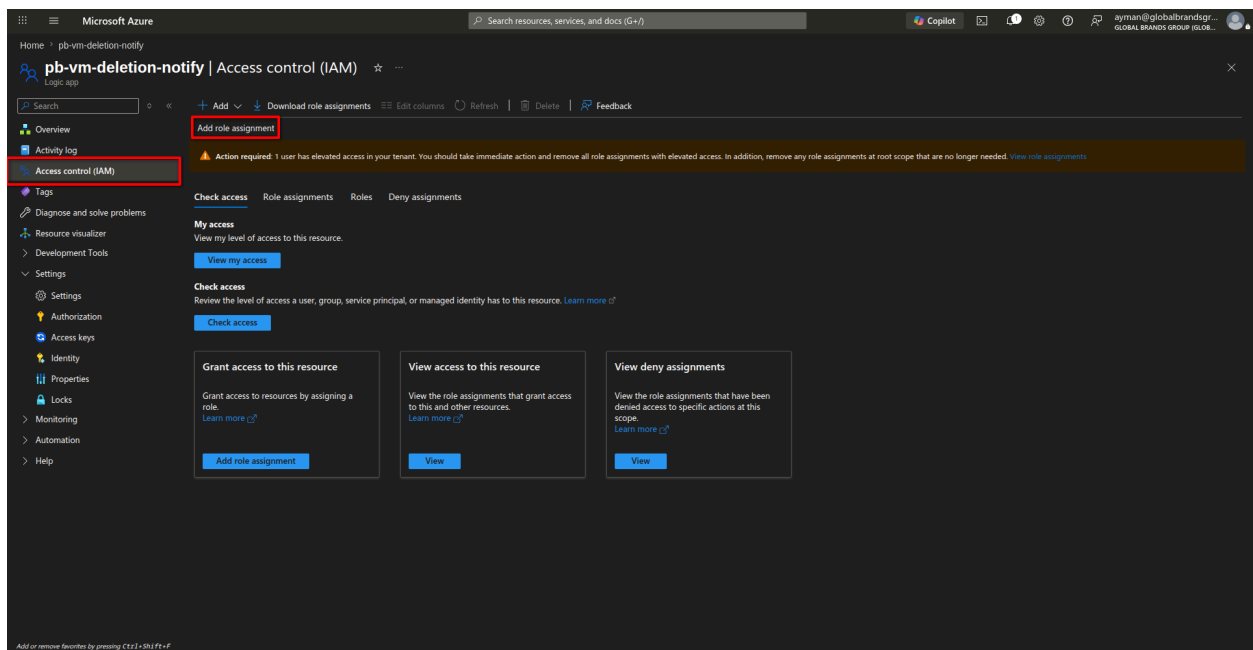
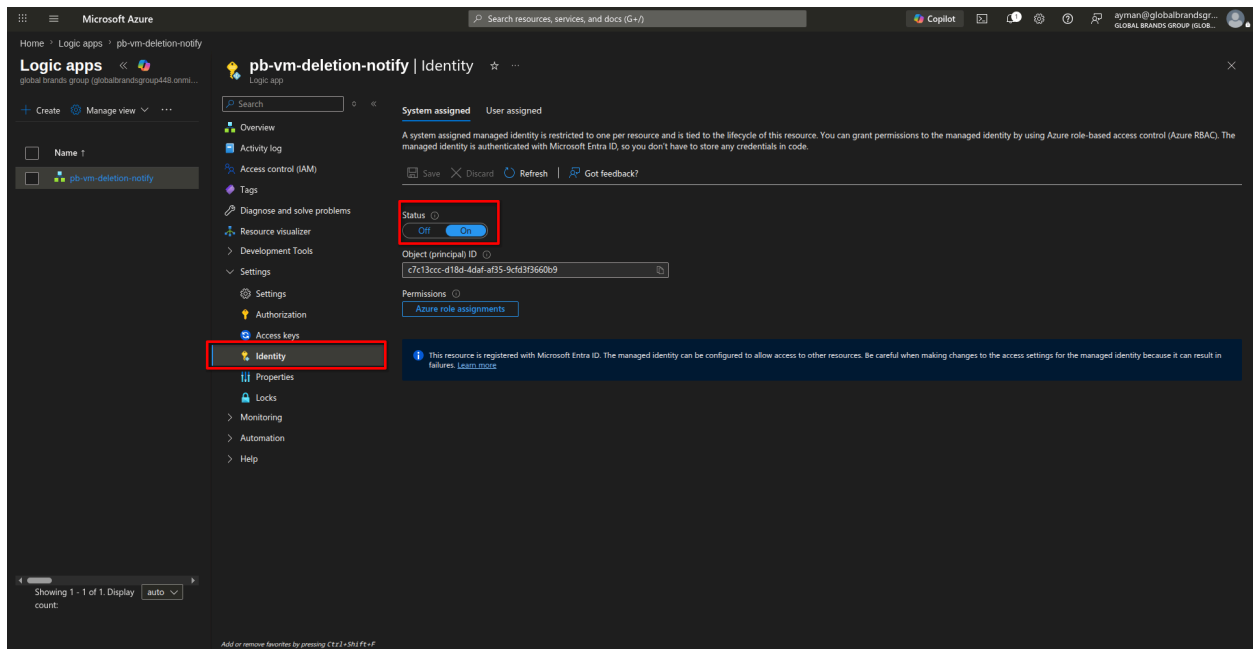
Add

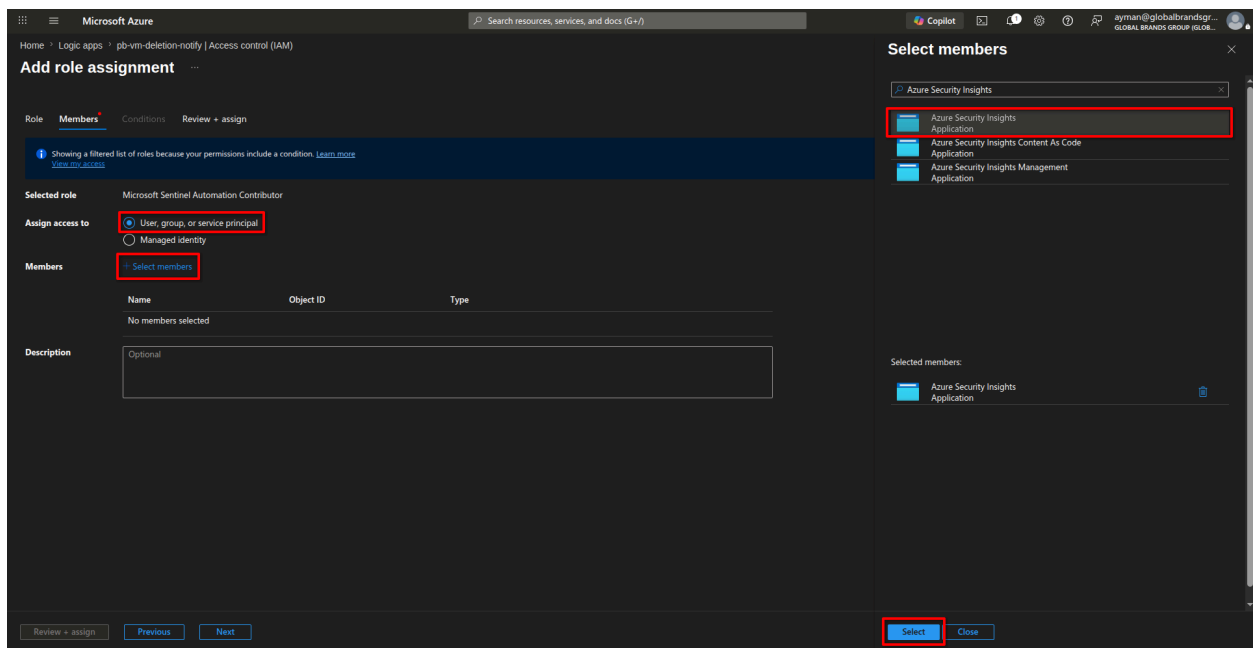
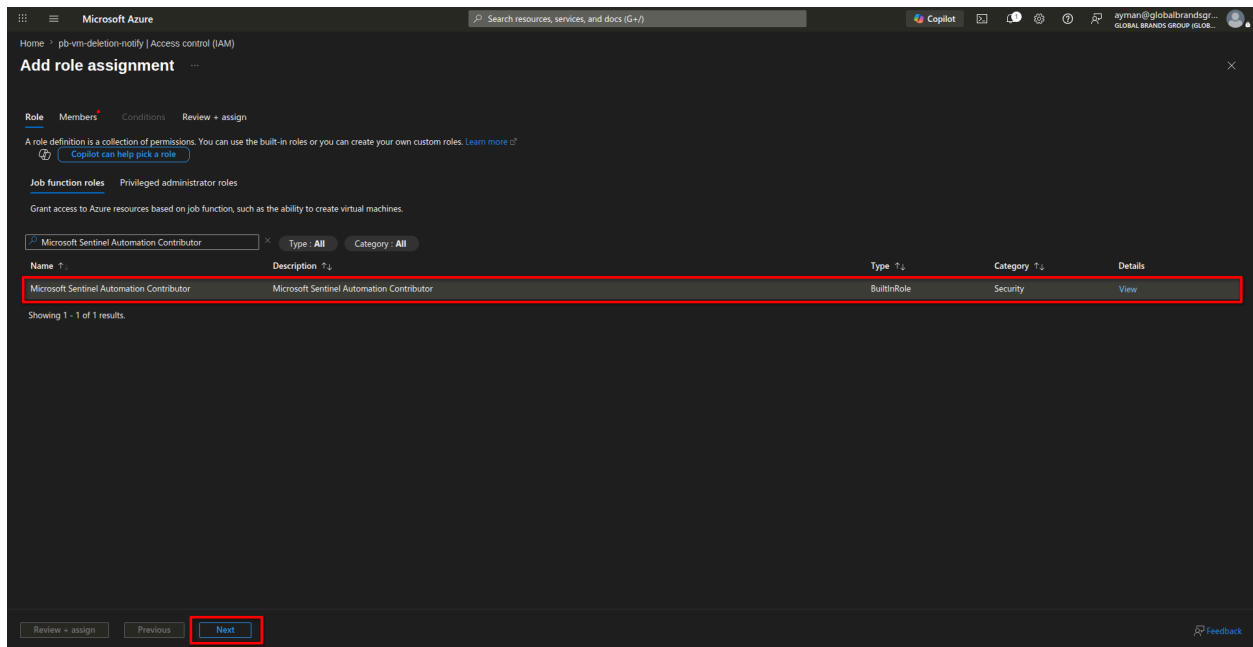


Step 8: Grant the Logic App's Managed Identity Access to Sentinel

If any playbook actions (like "Add comment to incident" or "Update incident") fail with a permissions error:

1. Logic App → **Identity** (left menu) → confirm **System assigned** identity is **On**.
2. Go to your **Sentinel workspace** → **Access control (IAM)**.
3. **+ Add role assignment** → role: **Microsoft Sentinel Playbook Operator** (or Contributor if you need broader access).
4. Assign to: your Logic App's managed identity (search by the Logic App's name).
5. Save.





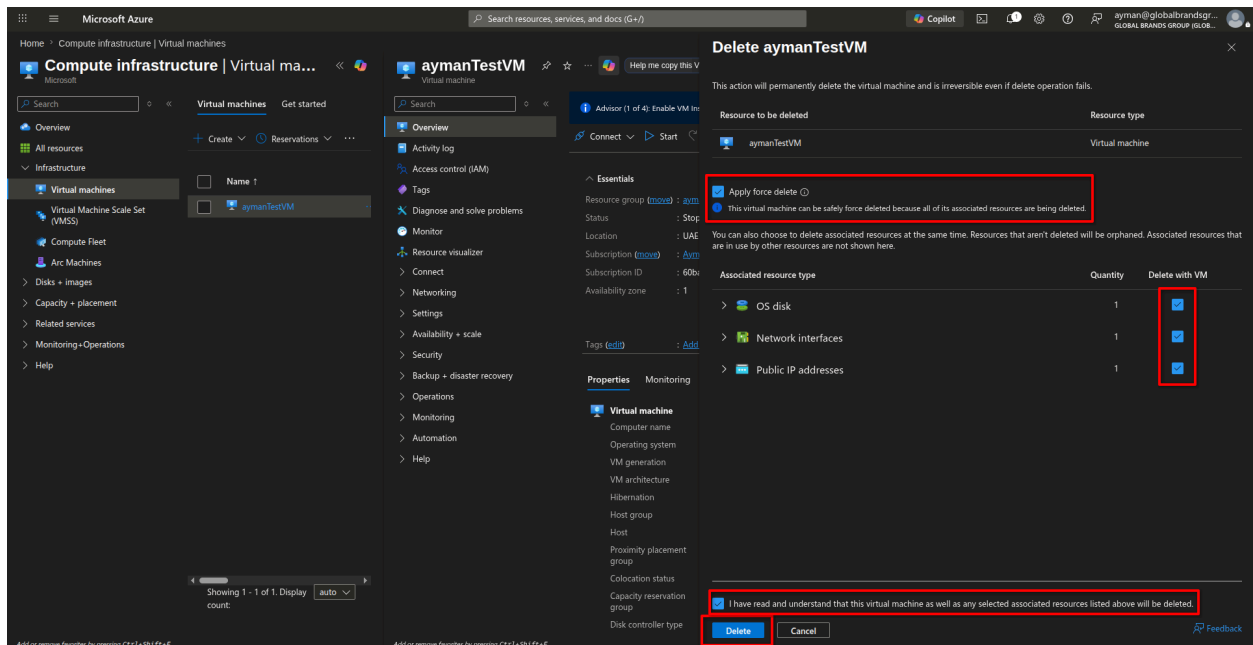
Step 9: Wire It Together and Test End-to-End

1. Go back to your Automation Rule (Step 6) and confirm the **Run playbook** action points to the now-built and tested Logic App.
2. Delete a disposable test VM in your subscription.

3. Watch for:

- **AzureActivity** row appears (Step 3 query)
- Analytics rule fires → incident created
- Automation rule triggers → playbook runs
- Teams message posts with correct entity data
- Comment appears on the incident

If something breaks, check in this order: data ingestion (Step 3) → KQL match (Step 4) → entity mapping on the rule (Step 5) → automation rule condition match (Step 6) → playbook trigger/action errors (Step 7–8, check Logic App run history for the failed step).



Microsoft Defender

Alerts > VM Deletion Detected

Part of incident: VM Deletion Detected [View incident page](#)

ayman

VM Deletion Detected
[View rule in Sentinel](#)

Rule description

Related events

Query results

View query 1 item [Customize columns](#)

TimeGenerated	Caller	CallerIpAddress	ResourceGroup	Resource	ResourceId
Jul 10, 2026 4:59:27 PM	ayman@globalbrandgr...	197.53.119.117	AYMAN-RG-TEST1	/subscriptions/60ba34d6-e952-486b-b30d-a3109360cd74/resourcegroups/ayman-rg-test1/providers/Microsoft.Security/insights/alerts/sna35c6153-c3df-4280-be3f-37eab20e1e71	/subscriptions/60ba34d6-e952-486b-b30d-a3109360cd74/resourcegroups/ayman-rg-test1/providers/Microsoft.Security/insights/alerts/sna35c6153-c3df-4280-be3f-37eab20e1e71

ActivityStatusValue: Success

VM Deletion Detected
High | Unknown | **New**

Manage alert | Move alert to another incident

Insight
Quickly classify this alert
Classify alerts to improve alert accuracy and get more insights about threats to your organization.
[Classify alert](#)

Alert state

Classification: Not Set [Set Classification](#)

Assigned to: Unassigned

Alert details

Alert ID: sna35c6153-c3df-4280-be3f-37eab20e1e71

Categories: Impact

MITRE ATT&CK Techniques: T1485: Data Destruction

Detection source: Scheduled detection

Service source: Microsoft Sentinel

Detection technology:

Microsoft Defender

Incidents > VM Deletion Detected

ID 276: VM Deletion Detected
High | Active | Unassigned | Unclassified | Last update time: Jul 10, 2026 5:09 PM | Critical asset

Attack story | Alerts (1) | Activities (2) | Assets (2) | Investigations (0) | Evidence and Response (1) | Summary

Filters: Severity: Any | Status: Any | Service sources: Any | [Add filter](#)

Detection & Categories

Active alerts: 1/1

Categories: 1

First activity: Jul 10, 2026 4:59:27 PM

Last activity: Jul 10, 2026 4:59:27 PM

Creation time: Jul 10, 2026 5:09:10 PM

Alerts

Jul 10, 2026 4:59 PM | New

VM Deletion Detected

ayman | aymanestvm

[Run playbook](#)

[Activities](#)

[Ask Defender Experts](#)

[Export incident as PDF](#)

[Merge incidents](#)

[Link incident to case](#)

[Report incident inaccuracy](#)

Incident graph

Layout | Group similar nodes | Entity types

ayman

aymanestvm

197.53.119.117

Communication | Association

Microsoft Defender

Incidents > VM Deletion Detected

ID 276: VM Deletion Detected

High | Active | Unassigned | Unclassified | Last update time

Attack story Alerts (1) Activities (2) Assets (2) Investigations (0)

Filters: Severity: Any Status: Any Service sources: Any

Detection & Categories

Active alerts 1/1 Categories 1

First activity Jul 10, 2026 4:59:27 PM Last activity Jul 10, 2026 4:59:27 PM

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Alerts

Jul 10, 2026 4:59 PM New VM Deletion Detected

ayman ayman-testvm

Run playbook on incident

Incident: VM Deletion Detected, ID: 1

Playbooks Runs

Select a playbook to run now on the incident. Only enabled playbooks configured with the Microsoft Sentinel incident trigger can be triggered.

Refresh 1 item Search

Filter set: Subscription: All Add filter Reset all

Name	Subscription	Resource group	Plan	Action
pb-vm-deletion-notfy	Ayman-Visual Studio E...	ayman-rg-test1		Run playbook

Microsoft Defender

Incidents > VM Deletion Detected

ID 276: VM Deletion Detected

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Detection & Categories

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Jul 10, 2026 4:59 PM New VM Deletion Detected

ayman ayman-testvm

Run playbook on incident

Incident: VM Deletion Detected, ID: 1

Playbooks Runs

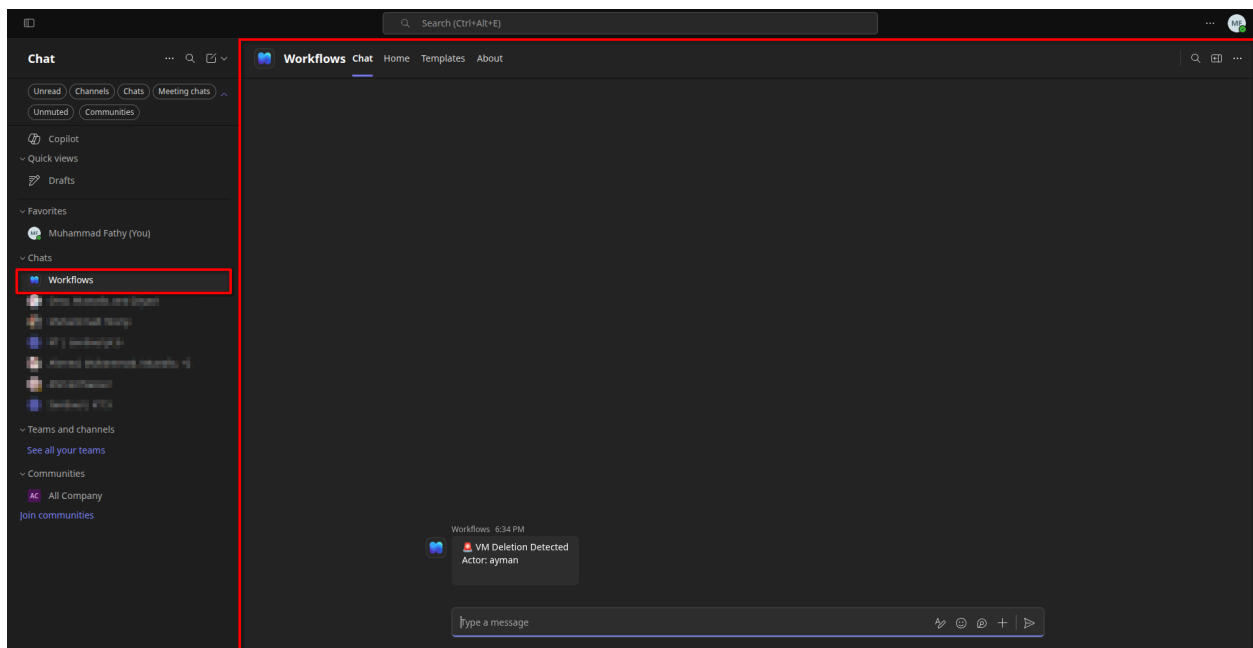
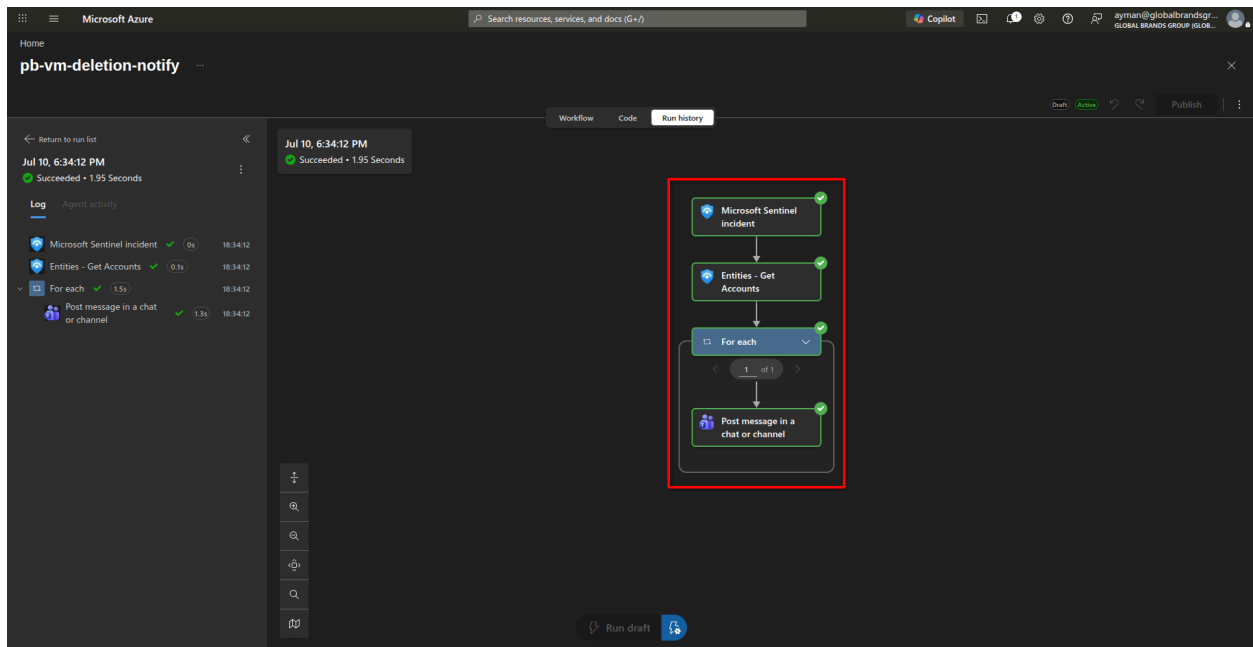
Playbook pb-vm-deletion-notfy was triggered successfully

Select a playbook to run now on the incident. Only enabled playbooks configured with the Microsoft Sentinel incident trigger can be triggered.

Refresh 1 item Search

Filter set: Subscription: All Add filter Reset all

Name	Subscription	Resource group	Plan	Action
pb-vm-deletion-notfy	Ayman-Visual Studio E...	ayman-rg-test1		Run playbook



Prerequisites Summary

Data & connectors

- Azure Activity connector installed via Content Hub

- Diagnostic setting sending **Administrative** category logs to the Sentinel workspace, scoped to the correct subscription

Permissions

- **Owner** or **Monitoring Contributor** at subscription scope (to configure diagnostic settings)
- **Microsoft Sentinel Contributor** on the workspace (to build analytics/automation rules)
- **Logic App Contributor** (or Contributor) on the resource group hosting the playbook
- **Microsoft Sentinel Playbook Operator** role assigned to the Logic App's managed identity

Licensing

- No Defender add-on required — **AzureActivity** ingestion is standard Log Analytics/Sentinel billing, not gated behind Defender product licensing

Connections

- Sentinel connector OAuth (Logic App)
- Teams connector OAuth, with the account/bot already a member of the target channel